

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Could it be true?



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What is an urban myth?
- What urban myths do you know?
- Why do you think people tell urban myths?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about myths and legends in different cultures.
- I can talk about past situations that did not happen.
- I can talk about things that happened or have happened or had happened.





Let's Explore!

A tale of **paranormal*** activity.

* "Paranormal" refers to something that can't be explained by science.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

My grandfather loved to tell us chilling stories. This was always one of my favourites – the story about the silent woman.

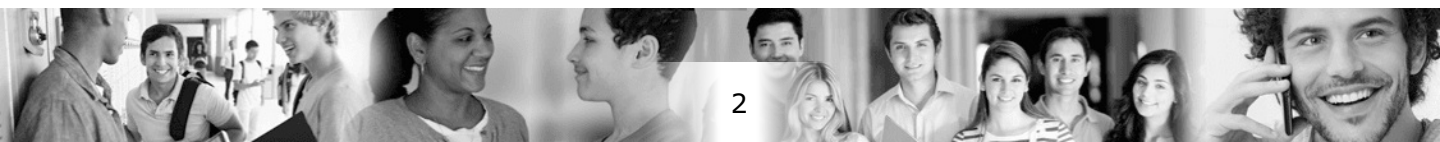
After the Depression had started in the 1930s, a lot of people were out of work. A woman came into a grocery store. She looked tired and hungry and pale. She was carrying two milk bottles. Wordlessly, she placed put them on the counter and the grocer picked them up. He exchanged them for full ones, saying: "Ten cents, please." She said nothing. She just took the bottles and left. He would have gone after her to demand his money if she hadn't looked so sad. He could see how hungry she was. He had always felt guilty because he had a job and food when others didn't. If he had not been so lucky, he would not be employed now. She had probably just lost her job, he decided. If she had had the money, she would have paid.

She came back again the next day as well with her empty bottles. He passed her two full ones and she hurried away. If she hadn't left so quickly, he would have spoken to her. The next morning she was there again. She looked so pale and tired that he felt badly for her. He wanted to talk to her. He wanted to offer her a job. However, before he was able to talk to her, she had run out of the store. After she had walked a block down the street, he followed her.

He was surprised to see her headed away from the town, down by the river and then into the graveyard there. He saw her hurry up to a headstone, where she seemed to disappear down into the earth. He stood there shocked. He couldn't believe what he had seen. Then, he heard something. It was the muffled cry of a baby. He moved toward the gravestone where he had last seen the woman and looked down. The sound was coming from beneath his feet!

He ran yelling down the street, calling for the police, for anyone to come. Within minutes, there was a swarm of people around the gravesite. When they heard the baby cry, they ran for shovels and started to dig.

When the casket was raised up out of the ground, a still hush came over the people standing around it as it was opened. The grocer looked in. The pale frail woman who had visited his store was laying dead inside it. In her arms, there was baby, and two full milk bottles. The baby squirmed and opened its eyes. It was still alive.





Let's Practice!

Legends always belong to the past.

Instructions: Circle the correct option to complete the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. She **was** / **had to** / **has been** back the next day with two empty milk bottles.
2. He **replaced** / **has replaced** / **had replaces** them with full bottles and **had watched** / **has watched** / **watched** as she hurried out the door.
3. After she **walking** / **had walked** / **has walked** a block down the street, he followed her.
4. She **heads away** / **had headed away** / **has headed away** from the migrant camp outside of town and toward the graveyard by the river.
5. The store owner saw the woman who **visit** / **had visited** / **was visit** his store laying dead within it.



Let's Practice!

Urban legends are part of our traditions.

Instructions: Read the text on page 2 again. Select the correct answer. Read the sentence aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. What happened when the man called the police?
 - a. People started going away.
 - b. A lot of people showed up at the graveyard.
 - c. Nobody wanted to be involved.
 - d. The police never came.
2. When they opened the casket ...
 - a. they saw a mommy.
 - b. it was empty.
 - c. a woman was in it.
 - d. the store owner went inside it.
3. The baby was ...
 - a. drinking milk.
 - b. alive.
 - c. asleep.
 - d. dead.





Extension Activity

Find a local urban legend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research some local urban legends.
- Write the urban legend in your own words.
- Read your urban legend to a group.
- Listen to the other legends.
- Discuss which ones you think could be possible.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research urban legends on the Internet.

☐ ☐

I write an urban legend in my own words.

☐ ☐

I read my urban legend aloud.

☐ ☐

I discuss urban legends.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- wordlessly** (adverb): without speaking
e.g. She wordlessly placed them on the counter.
- the Depression** (noun): the period of economic downturn from 1929 until the start of the Second World War
e.g. After the Depression had started, the woman came to his shop carrying two empty milk bottles.
- graveyard** (noun): a place where dead people are buried
e.g. To his surprise, she had headed away from the migrant camp outside of town and toward the graveyard by the river.
- gravestone** (noun): a stone with writing on it which marks the place where a person is buried
e.g. It was coming from the ground underneath the gravestone where the woman had disappeared!
- casket** (noun): a long box used to bury a dead person
e.g. When the casket was opened, the store owner saw the woman who had visited his store laying dead within it.
- muffled** (adjective): quieter; less clear
e.g. Then he heard the muffled cry of a baby.
- to swarm** (verb): to move with a large group
e.g. Within minutes, the graveyard was swarming with people
- to exchange** (verb): to change something for something else of a similar value or type
e.g. She came again the next morning, and exchanged her empty bottles for full without saying a word.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect Tense: Unreal Past

When you talk about the unreal past, you use past tenses to talk about hypothetical situations. You use the Past Perfect tense for unlikely or unreal situations in the past.

The structure of the Past Perfect tense is:

subject + had + past participle

You use it with an If clause to contain the meaning of unreal past.

If I had known, I would have ...

This means you didn't know, but if you did you would have done something different.

Look at the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *If he had not been so lucky, he would not be employed now.*
- *If she had had the money, she would have paid.*
- *He would have gone after her to demand his money if she hadn't looked so sad.*
- *If she hadn't left so quickly, he would have spoken to her.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense and the Past Perfect Tense

You use the perfect tenses when you want to talk about events that are connected to another event in some way.

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action that happened at an unspecified time in the past. You do not refer to any point in the time when you use the Present Perfect.

For example:

*I **have studied** German.*

You also use the Present Perfect tense to talk about an action that started in the past and continues up to the present.

*I've **just started** dinner.*

You use the Past Perfect tense to refer to a completed action in the past that happened before another past action.

For example:

*I **had studied** German before I went to Germany.*

First: I studied German,

Second: I went to Germany.

Examples:

- *She has probably just lost her job, he decided.*
- *After the Depression had started, the woman came to his shop carrying two empty milk bottles.*
- *Before he was able to talk to her, she had run out of the store.*
- *After she had walked a block down the street, he followed her.*
- *He had always felt a little guilty at being one of the lucky ones with money and a job.*

